

A BOOK OF TASTE / IV

The Patisserie of the Unconscious

Tiramisu

CARE



The gentlest luxuries are the ones meant to be shared.

HISTORY / 01

The Pick-Me-Up

Older tradition · The Veneto



Long before the cake, the Veneto had its restoratives: egg yolks beaten with sugar — sbatudìn, zabaione — given to children, the tired, the recovering.

The idea was already there: something soft and sweet and gently strengthening, made at home to lift a body that was flagging.

HISTORY / 02

Born in Treviso

Late 1960s — early 1970s · Treviso



In Treviso, the modern tiramisù took shape — most often credited to the restaurant Le Beccherie and the family and pastry cook behind it.

Mascarpone, espresso-soaked savoiardi, egg, sugar and cocoa were layered into something new. Its name came from the dialect: tirame sù — 'pick me up.'

HISTORY / 03

The Name Travels

1980s · Italy



Printed in cookbooks and copied from kitchen to kitchen, tiramisù spread out of the Veneto and across Italy within a decade.

Every region bent it a little — more coffee, a splash of liqueur, a different biscuit — but the gesture stayed the same.

The World's Dessert

Today · Everywhere



Tiramisù is now perhaps the most recognised Italian dessert on earth, found on menus from Tokyo to Buenos Aires.

For all its fame it kept its humble character: no baking, no spectacle — just coffee, cream and the wish to lift someone's day.

AFTERTASTE

A local pick-me-up had become a way of caring for one another.

A SMALL PRACTICE

Make something for someone who is tired — not to impress them, but simply to lift them. Let the small ritual of coffee and cream be the whole gift.

Who in your life could use a little lifting — and how might a taste say it for you?

RECIPE / INGREDIENTS

Classic Tiramisù

The traditional Italian layered coffee dessert.

- 4 egg yolks
- 100 g sugar
- 500 g mascarpone
- 300 ml strong espresso, cooled
- 200 g savoiardi (ladyfinger biscuits)
- 2 tbsp cocoa powder
- a splash of Marsala or dark rum, optional



RECIPE / METHOD

- 01 Whisk the yolks and sugar until pale and thick.
 - 02 Fold in the mascarpone until smooth.
 - 03 Stir the cooled espresso (and Marsala, if using) in a shallow dish.
 - 04 Dip each ladyfinger briefly — soaked, not soggy.
 - 05 Line a dish with a layer of biscuits.
 - 06 Spread over half the mascarpone cream.
 - 07 Repeat with a second layer of biscuits and cream.
 - 08 Chill at least 4 hours, then dust generously with cocoa before serving.
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Tiramisù is barely cooked at all — its whole art is in the layering, and in who you make it for.